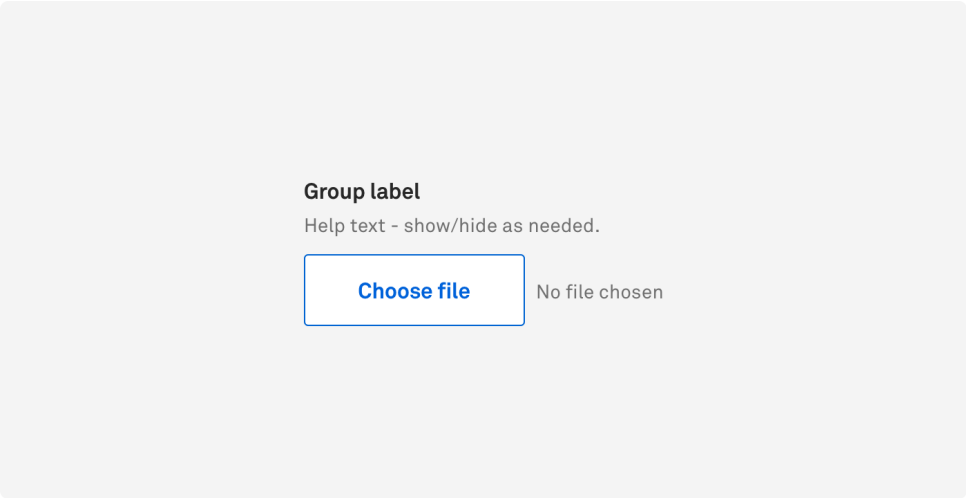
File Picker

Created by Genevieve Wang, last modified on 18 Feb 2021



Version

1

Availability

Web

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File Picker lets users choose one or more files from their device to upload within a form.

Useful Docs

- Design Tips on Uploading

Specs

- Specs (Coming soon)

UI Playground

- Web Playground
- React Playground

Usage Guidelines

A File Picker is used:

- To ask users to upload a file if it's critical to the delivery of your service.
- To allow users to upload one or many files.
- In web forms only.

Don't use File Picker when:

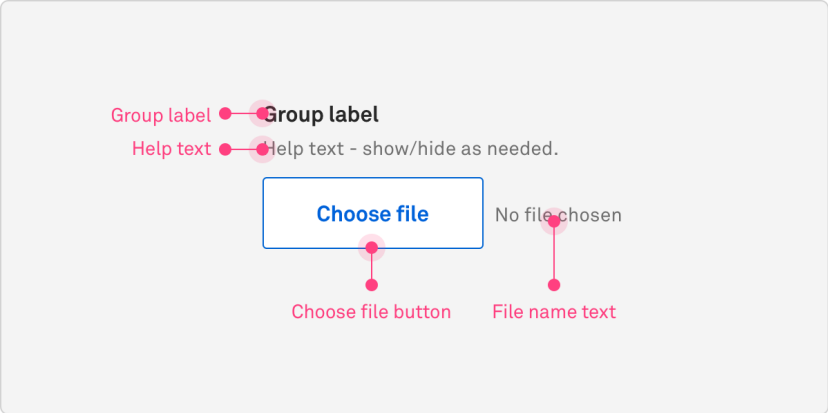
- User needs to remove/clear a file selection. (See Limitations on File Picker for more info)
- You're required to display a list of files selected by the user. (See Limitations on File Picker for more info)

Limitations of Using File Picker

File Picker is built using native File Input. There are some limitations in how File Picker behaves:

- **Unable to clear existing selection.**
  When a file has been selected, the native control does not provide the functionality to remove or clear the existing selection without refreshing the page or restarting the flow.
- **Upload does not happen immediately on file selection.**
  The "upload" action does not take effect until users click on a submit button. Keep in mind that there may be additional waiting time for the actual upload after user clicks on the submit button.
- **File selection does not stack.**
  To replacing a selected file(s), user must use File Picker to pick a new selection again. To choose multiple files to upload, user must select all files in one go. File selection does not stack. (Consider using multiple File Pickers as an alternative.)
- **File names are not displayed when uploading multiple files.**
  The File Picker control shows the file name when 1 file is selected. However, when multiple files are selected, the control only shows the number of files selected, not a list of file names.
- **Users can only select multiple files from the same document folder.**
  Consider using multiple File Pickers to select multiple files.

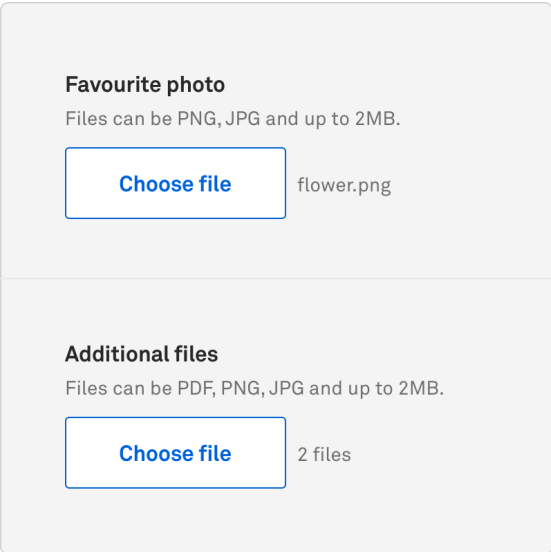
Anatomy



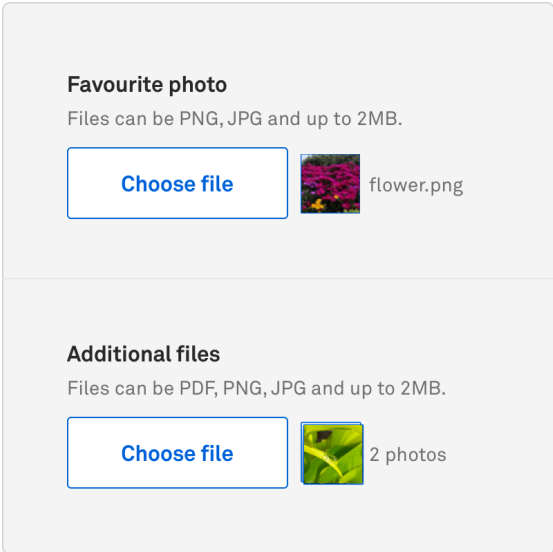
Different UI in Different Browser

File Picker is built using native File Input provided by each web browser. The component may look slightly different on different browsers due to the limitations on which UI elements can be modified.

Desktop Web



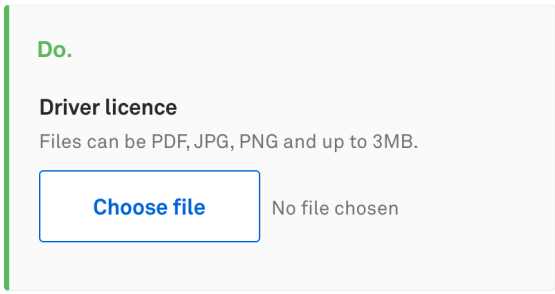
Mobile Web



Note: File Picker in mobile web allows users to either upload a file from device storage or directly from device cameras.

Best Practices

- **Be clear and upfront on upload requirements in the help text.**
  Users should be informed of the file size limit, accepted file type, or number of files that can be uploaded. For copy guidance, see Help Text.



- **Be flexible in allowing different file formats.**
  When uploading a photograph or document, allow users to upload relevant formats that may be used. For photograph, it should include JPG, PNG, GIF, PDF, etc.
- **Prevent users from selecting irrelevant or unaccepted file types.**
  If we're asking the user to upload a copy of their driver licence, don't allow them to upload a video file, such as MP4, MOV, etc. Be sure to define a list of accepted file types in the help text to prevent user from choosing unaccepted files.
- **Check what's been uploaded and provide feedback ASAP.**
  E.g. If user selects a file that exceeds the file size or number limit, be sure to surface the error text to inform the users. For copy guidance, see Error Text.

Do.

Profile photo

Files can be JPG, PNG, GIF and up to 2MB.

Choose file avatar.jpg

File exceeds the max size of 2MB.

- **Use multiple file pickers to upload multiple files.**
  Avoid asking users to upload multiple files via a single File Picker as they may face difficulties navigating the specific behaviours of each browser (see Limitations on File Picker for more info).

Do.

Birth certificate

Files can be PDF, JPG and up to 5MB.

Choose file No file chosen

Medicare card

Files can be PDF, JPG and up to 5MB.

Choose file No file chosen

Don't.

Birth certificate and Medicare card

Files can be PDF, JPG and up to 5MB.

Choose file No file chosen

Content Guidelines

1. Group Label
2. Help Text
3. Error Text
4. Choose File Button & File Name Text

1. Label

The File Picker label should clearly request what files are required from the user and should be visible to users **at all times**.

When writing the label:

- Specify the exact kind of file required. Don't be vague.
- Avoid using verbs like 'Upload / Attach / Browse'. Keep it consistent with the other labels in Text Field and Checkbox Group within the same page.
- Use singular or plural form to indicate how many files a user can or should upload.

Do.

Medical certificate

Additional document/s

Don't.

Upload file

Attach / Select / Browse file

How to mark optional fields?

- Mark optional fields by appending "(optional)" at the end of the label.
- Don't mark required fields with asterisks (*), as it adds confusion and not everyone knows what this character means.
- Don't put "This is a required field" in help text. Help text is reserved for input requirements and instructions.

Do.

Citizenship certificate (optional)

Don't.

Citizenship certificate (required)

Citizenship certificate*

2. Help Text

If there are specifications, requirements or limitations for uploading files, this **input guidance must be included** in the help text to help the user select an appropriate file.

Users should be informed of requirements regarding:

- Accepted file types
- Accepted file size

When writing help text requirements:

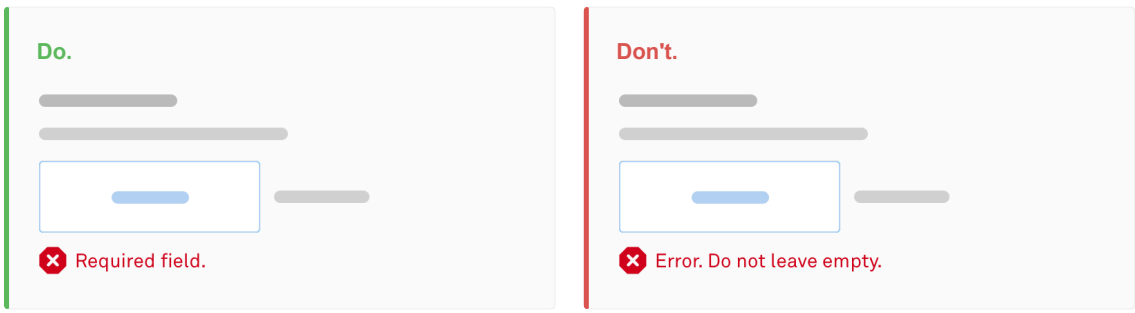
- Call out all key requirements a user must consider.
- Phrase requirements in a format that is widely accessible. Don't assume certain terms or abbreviations are clear on their own to all users.
- Follow the guidelines on formatting abbreviations in Telstra's Content Style Guide.

3. Error Text

Error text must provide clear instruction to users on what the error is and how to fix it. Don't let users guess what the solution should be.

Required field.

If users forget to upload a file that is required, the error text should always say 'Required field'.



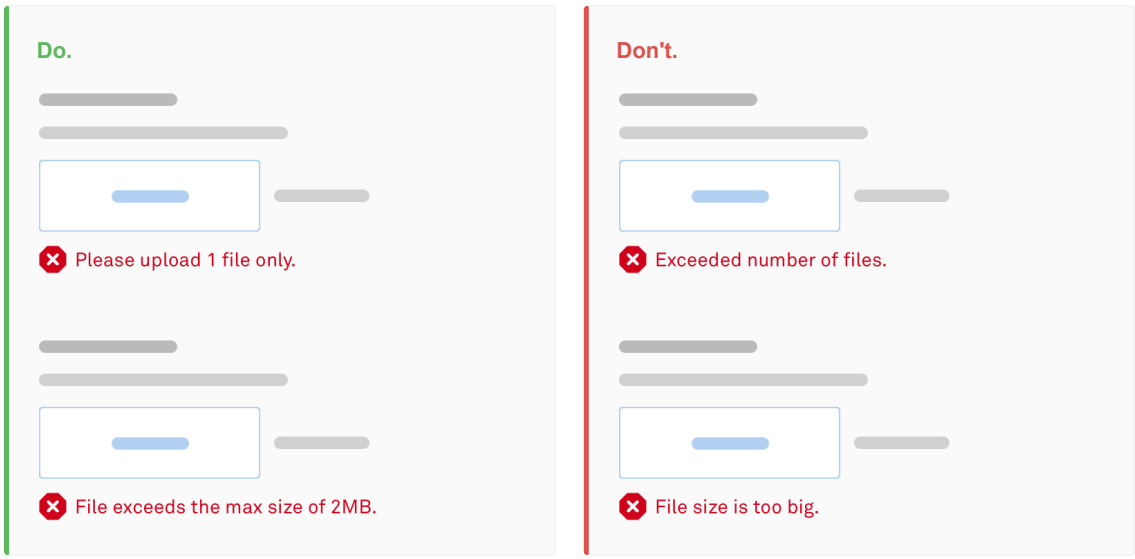
File Requirement Errors

File Picker allows you to define certain file types that can be selected, meaning a user will be prevented from selecting an incompatible file type. However, backend systems may have additional requirements around file size and the number of files accepted. If these conditions return as failed from the server, it should be displayed as an error message.

When writing error text:

- Indicate the issue and instruct how to fix it. The more specific you can be about the problem and solution, the better.
- Be short and concise, avoid lengthy sentences.
- Use passive voice, so user doesn't feel like they're being blamed for the error.

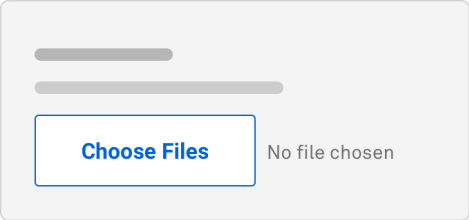
Note: Prevent these errors from occurring by clearly outlining any requirements in the help text.



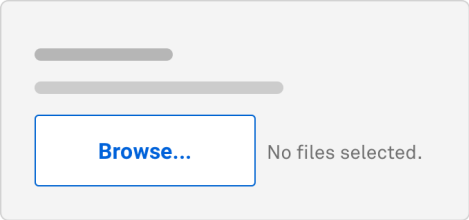
4. Choose File Button & File Name Text

The copy & capitalisation in the Choose File Button & File Name Text is provided by the native browser. It varies across browsers and **cannot be modified** as shown below.

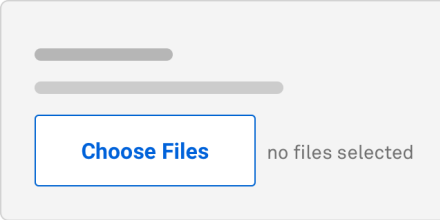
Chrome



Firefox



Safari



For more copy guidance, please refer to Telstra's Content Style Guide.

Accessibility Considerations

File Picker uses the native HTML form element <input> of type="file". To view the accessibility requirements we must meet please refer to the WCAG 2.1 Success Criteria outlined within Text Field

Keyboard

- Users must be able to navigate to and interact with the control using keyboard alone.
- A clear visible indicator should also be present when the control has focus.

Interaction	Keystrokes
Navigating	TAB moves keyboard focus to the control
Activation	SPACEBAR or ENTER activates the control and triggers the file picker dialog

Screenreader

Screen reader behaviour and the ordering of announcements will vary depending on the platform/browser/screen reader combinations being used.

On screen reader focus, announcements may include:

- The **label** *(full support)*
- The **role** such as *button or File upload button (full support)*
- Any **help text** that is associated with the control *(partial support depending on screen reader)*
- If the field is **required** *(partial support depending on screen reader)*
- If the field is **invalid** *(partial support depending on screen reader)*

Currently the error message is not announced on the tested platforms.

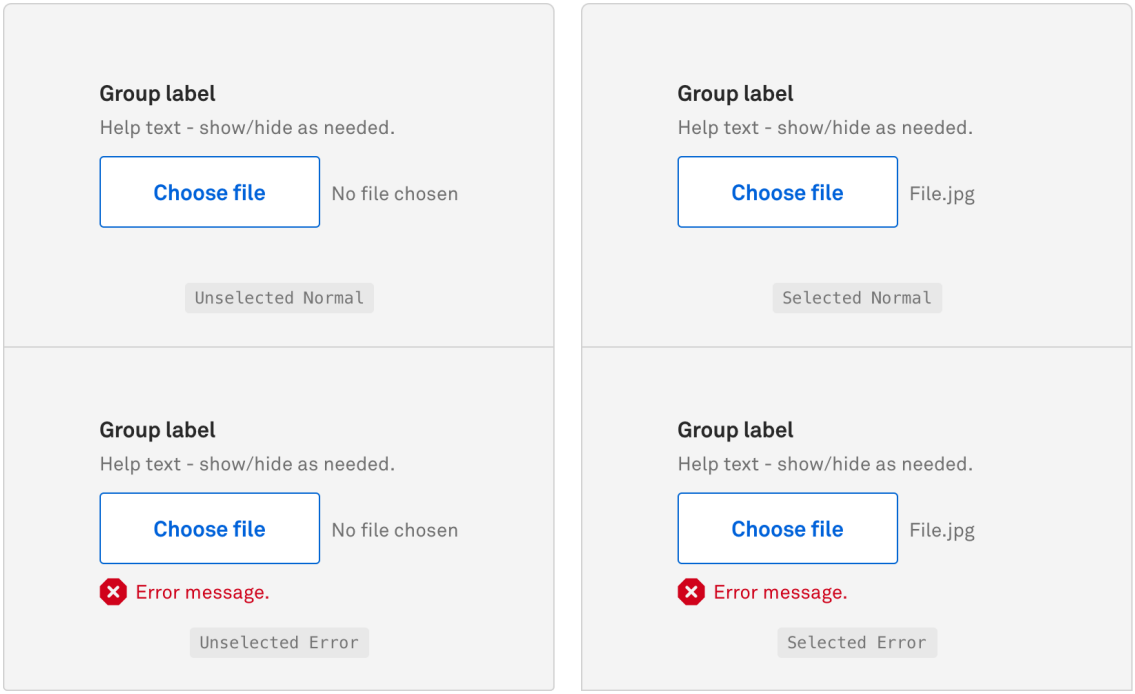
Supported States

There are 4 unique states — each communicates the state of the checkbox as users interact with it. To find out more details on the different states, see Interaction States.

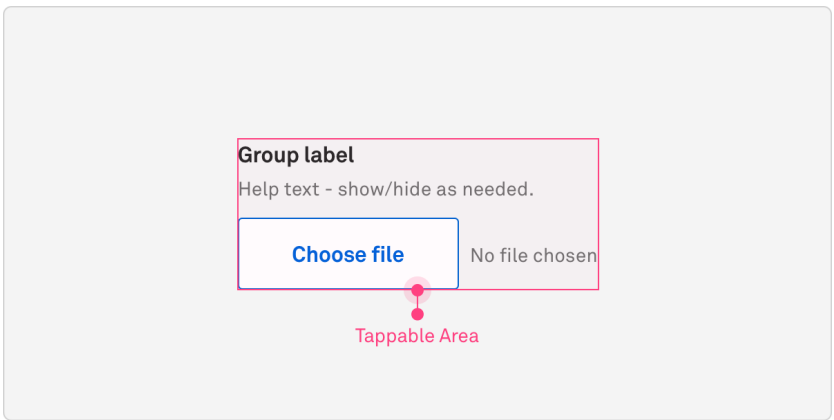
File Picker can be:

- Unselected Normal
- Unselected Error
- Selected Normal
- Selected Error

Find out more details on the different states, see Action Button Medium Emphasis.



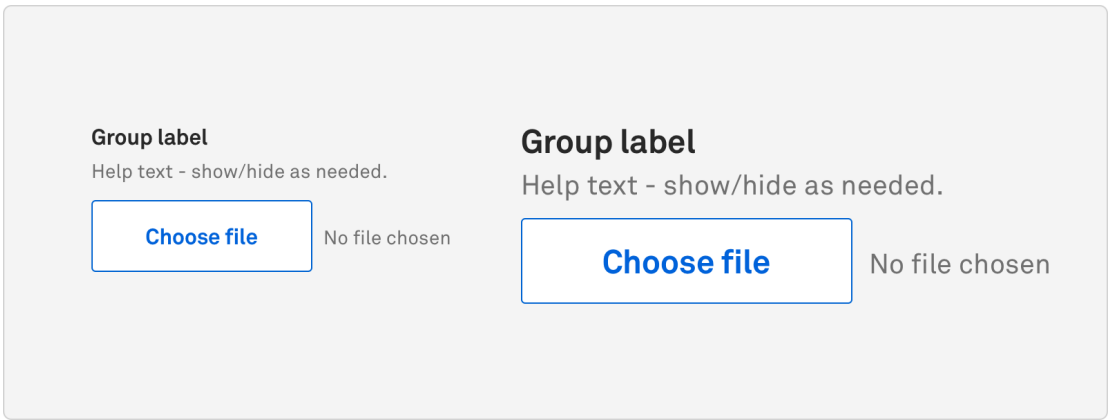
Tappable Area



File Picker has a minimum height of 52px that allows users to easily change their selection.

Clicking on the Choose File button will display the operating system's file selector dialogue.

Capabilities



Robust Layout.

Components are scaled automatically based on the font size and zoom level in user's browser settings.

Related Patterns

- Text Field
- Action Button
- File Upload (*coming soon*)

No labels

Atlassian